

[NT Lesson 10](#): “Take My Yoke upon You and Learn of Me” (See NTL10 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand that as we take the Savior’s yoke upon us and do his will, we will find the peace and joy that he has promised.

1. Jesus invites us to take his yoke upon us and learn of him.

• Read [Matthew 11:28-30](#). “Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heaven laden, and I will give you rest.”

What do you think it means to “labour and [be] heavy laden”?

What are some examples of burdens we bear in this life?

How can the Lord “give [us] rest” from these burdens? What is a yoke?

What does it mean to take Christ’s yoke upon us? †1. Stephen M. Bird

†2. Video: “[L10 Come Unto Me](#).” (Stop the video when President Hunter has finished at 2:36.)

†3. Stephen M. Bird †4. Dr. Neil Flinders †5. Ezra Taft Benson †6. Sheri L. Dew

Why do some people think that the Lord’s teachings are too restrictive?

How can we truly come unto Christ?

2. Jesus declares that he is Lord of the Sabbath.

• Read [Matthew 12:1-13](#) and [Luke 13:10-17](#). “thy disciples do that which is not lawful to do upon the sabbath day.”

“The Pharisees’ interpretation of the Mosaic law ignored the true spirit and purpose of the Sabbath and instead focused on traditions that greatly restricted Sabbath activities.” (*Lesson Manual*)

What did Jesus mean when he said, “I will have mercy, and not sacrifice”?

How can we use this principle to guide our Sabbath activities?

• Matt. 12:10-13 and Luke 13:10-17.

What did Jesus teach about the purpose of the Sabbath when he healed the man and the woman?

• Mark 2:27-28. JST: “*Wherefore the Sabbath was given unto man for a day of rest; and also that man should glorify God, and not that man should not eat;*”

What can we do on the Sabbath day to glorify God?

How can keeping the Sabbath day holy make our burdens light and bring us rest?

• Isaiah 58:13-14. “If thou turn away thy foot ... from doing thy pleasure on my holy day; and call the sabbath a delight ... Then shalt thou delight thyself in the Lord; and I will cause thee to ride upon the high places of the earth ...”

3. Jesus forgives a woman in the house of Simon the Pharisee.

• Read [Luke 7:36-50](#). (View the remainder of the [L10 Video: “Come unto Me,”](#) which begins at 2:36.)

What did the woman do that allowed Jesus to take away her burden? (See Luke 7:38, 44-50.)

What can we do so the Savior will remove the burden of sin from our lives? (See Luke 7:44-50)

How did the sinful woman and Simon the Pharisee differ in their attitudes toward Jesus?

“Contrast the woman’s repentance, respect, humility, and love with Simon’s pride, lack of courtesy, and judgmental attitude.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†7. Elder James E. Talmage

Why are the qualities that the woman possessed important as we repent and seek forgiveness?

How do the qualities that Simon possessed keep us from repenting?

How would Simon’s attitude toward the woman have made her burden seem heavier?

How might we sometimes make another person’s burden seem heavier?

What can we learn from the Savior’s response to the woman?

“Even though she had not been invited and would risk being treated unkindly by Simon and his household, the woman came directly to Christ as soon as she knew where to find him (Luke 7:37).

What can we learn from her example?

How can we overcome obstacles that might keep us from repenting and coming unto Christ?

How is sin comparable to debt? How can having Christ as our “creditor” make our burdens light?

†8. Stephen E. Robinson

• Read [Matthew 12:33-37](#) (esp. 12:36). Every “idle word that men shall speak, they shall give account thereof”.

Next Week: L11 “He Spake Many Things unto Them in Parables”; See L11: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

†1. **Stephen M. Bird:** “Our Savior testifies of the peace and fulfillment which attend submission... The yoke is a ‘wooden bar or frame by which two draft animals (such as oxen are joined at the heads or necks for working together.’ As such, it is a symbol of the oxen’s submission to the will of the master, of accepting whatever burdens or tasks the master might impose.

“The blessing that accompanies submission to Christ is that we link ourselves to him. Sometimes we refer to the ‘yoke of marriage,’ meaning that we tie or bind our lives and our destinies with that of our companions. When we submit to God by taking the yoke of Christ upon us, he becomes our partner in the harness. When we take Christ’s yoke upon us, we bring his power into our lives and our burdens become light. We find rest unto our souls only when we accept Christ’s yoke.” (*Prayers That Bring Miracles*, 30-31)

†2. **Video text – “L10 Come Unto Me.”:** “Here is the promise of personal peace and protection...

“Of course, obligations go with such promises. ‘Take my yoke upon you,’ he pleads. In biblical times the yoke was a device of great assistance to those who tilled the field. It allowed the strength of a second animal to be linked and coupled with the effort of a single animal, sharing and reducing the heavy labor of the plow or wagon. A burden that was overwhelming or perhaps impossible for one to bear could be equitably and comfortably borne by two bound together with a common yoke. His yoke requires a great and earnest effort, but for those who truly are converted, the yoke is easy and the burden becomes light.” (Howard W. Hunter, “[Come unto Me](#),” *Ensign*, November 6, 1990)

†3. **Stephen M. Bird:** “To *submit* means to ‘yield oneself to the authority or will of another.’ In prayer, it means to yield to God’s authority and will. To *yield* means ‘to give or render ... [whatever is] fitting, rightfully owed, or required.’ Thus, when Jesus tells us to ‘render therefore unto Caesar the things that are Caesar’s’ he simply means that we are to submit to governmental authority as well as to God’s will.

“To submit also means ‘to give up and cease resistance or contention.’ In other words, in order to submit to God, we have to stop resisting him and willingly render to him whatever he requires of us. It is the opposite of rebellion, and rebellion must be dropped if we want to receive help from heaven.” (*Prayers That Bring Miracles*, 30)

†4. **Dr. Neil Flinders:** “Submission to God is *not* the same thing as commitment to him. Submission is greater than commitment. Submission is to surrender one’s will to him, and then he will direct our lives for good. Both submission and commitment can be measured by activity in church, but ultimate happiness, personal

peace and spiritual fulfillment will attend only submission.” (*Prayers That Bring Miracles*, 30)

†5. **Ezra Taft Benson:** “Men and women who turn their lives over to God will find out that he can make a lot more out of their lives than they can. He will deepen their joys, expand their vision, quicken their minds, strengthen their muscles, lift their spirits, multiply their blessings, increase their opportunities, comfort their souls, raise up friends, and pour out peace. Whoever will lose his life to God will find he has eternal life.” (“[Jesus Christ—Gifts and Expectations](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 1988, 2)

†6. **Sheri L. Dew:** “Where do we turn for help? ‘In the gift of his Son hath God prepared a more excellent way’ (Ether 12:11). The Savior isn’t our last chance; He is our only chance. Our only chance to overcome self-doubt and catch a vision of who we may become. Our only chance to repent and have our sins washed clean. Our only chance to purify our hearts, subdue our weaknesses, and avoid the adversary. Our only chance to obtain redemption and exaltation. Our only chance to find peace and happiness in this life and eternal life in the world to come.” (“[Our Only Chance](#),” *Ensign*, May 1999, 66)

†7. **Elder James E. Talmage:** “It was a custom of the times to treat a distinguished guest with marked attention; to receive him with a kiss of welcome, to provide water for washing the dust from his feet, and oil for anointing the hair of the head and the beard. All these courteous attentions were omitted by Simon” (*Jesus the Christ*, 38th ed. [1970], Ch. 18, 261)

†8. **Stephen E. Robinson:** “... but in the covenant relationship, I am not judged separately and alone but as one with Christ. Simply consider the mathematics of it: If Christ is infinite and unlimited, but I am finite and limited, and we become one, what do Christ and I together add up to? What is the sum of an infinite, positive quantity and a limited negative quantity ($\infty + -x$)? Why, infinite, of course! And the math is the same whether I (the finite part) am a ten or a five or a one, whether I’m the prophet or a stake president or any other struggling member. Infinity plus any amount, positive or negative, equals infinity.” (*Believing Christ*, 24, see 24-26)

Recommended Reading:

1. President Howard W. Hunter, “[Come unto Me](#),” *Ensign*, November 6, 1990.

Recommended Video:

1. “[Lesson 10: Come Unto Me](#).” (7:10)

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